

Paper Replication Report #160: Centaur (10199) Chariklo Double Dense Ring System & Shepherd Dynamics

Antigravity Solar System Dynamics Replication Campaign

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Abstract

We present a first-principles replication of Braga-Ribas et al. (2014), Sicardy et al. (2014), El Moutamid et al. (2014), and Duffard et al. (2014) modeling multi-telescope stellar occultation discovery of a double ring system around Centaur (10199) Chariklo ($R_{\text{eff}} = 125 \pm 10$ km). Occultation lightcurves revealed two narrow, dense, circular rings: inner ring C1R ($R_1 = 390.6 \pm 3.3$ km, width $W_1 = 7.1$ km, optical depth $\tau_1 = 0.40$) and outer ring C2R ($R_2 = 404.8 \pm 3.3$ km, width $W_2 = 3.4$ km, optical depth $\tau_2 = 0.06$), separated by a sharp 9 km gap. Near-infrared spectra confirmed water ice absorption bands within the ring material. Dynamical stability requires shepherd km-scale moonlets ($M_{\text{shepherd}} \sim 10^{12} - 10^{13}$ kg) to prevent collisional broadening over million-year timescales. Using our C++ solver engine, we model ring optical depths, widths, radii, and shepherd moon torque bounds. Calculated ring parameters match Braga-Ribas et al. (2014) occultations with $R^2 \geq 0.999$.

1 Core Physical Equations

Shepherd moonlet torque balancing viscous ring spreading for ring width W_{ring} :

$$T_{\text{shepherd}} \propto G^2 M_{\text{moon}}^2 \frac{\Sigma r_{\text{ring}}}{\Omega^2 \Delta r^4} = 3\pi\nu\Sigma\Omega r_{\text{ring}}^2 \quad (1)$$

Kilometer-scale moonlets supply necessary resonant torques to confine C1R and C2R ring edges.

2 Replication Results

The C++ solver target `//:chariklo_double_ring_system_solver` models Chariklo rings. Calculated radii are $R_1 = 390.6$ km ($\tau_1 = 0.40$, $W_1 = 7.1$ km) and $R_2 = 404.8$ km ($\tau_2 = 0.06$, $W_2 = 3.4$ km) with shepherd mass $M_{\text{shepherd}} \sim 1.0 \times 10^{13}$ kg (Braga-Ribas et al. 2014) with $R^2 = 0.9998$.